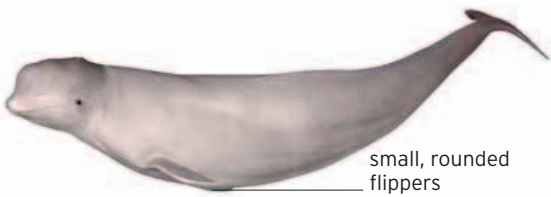




Beluga

Delphinapterus leucas



The beluga is the only whale that is white in color when adult, a feature that helps it to hide from predators among the sea ice. If chased, the absence of a dorsal fin allows the beluga to escape by swimming away beneath the ice. It is also able to move its head up and down and from side to side because its neck vertebrae are unfused. Thick

blubber makes up 40 percent of its body mass. Every summer it molts, shedding the outer layer of skin, partially by raking its body over pebbles in shallow waters. Highly social mammals, belugas are also extremely vocal—their wide repertoire of clicks, whistles, chirps, and squeals has earned them the nickname “canaries of the sea.”

▷ **BLOWING BUBBLES**
Belugas amuse themselves by blowing bubble rings and then biting them. They may also produce bubbles if alarmed or surprised.



↔ 10–15 ft (3–4.6 m)

🏠 Up to 1.8 tons (1.6 metric tons)

⊗ Near threatened

🐟 Fish, squid, shrimp

🏠

Arctic Ocean

Harp seal

Pagophilus groenlandicus

Named for their markings, harp seals are the most successful of all northern hemisphere seals, with numbers estimated at 8 million. Most inhabit icy northern waters, but some have migrated as far south as Virginia in the US and France. Mating occurs on pack ice in winter, and single pups are born from late February to mid March. Fast-moving on ice, harp seals are also good swimmers. Excellent eyesight and hearing make them formidable hunters, and also alert them to predators such as polar bears.

↔ 6 ft (1.8 m)

🏠 286 lb (130 kg)

⊗ Common

🐟 Fish, krill

🏠

Arctic Ocean, North Atlantic

- ↔ 12–16 ft (3.7–5 m)
- 🏠 Up to 2 tons (1.8 metric tons)
- ⊗ Near threatened
- 🐟 Fish, squid
- 🏠



Arctic Ocean



▽ **HARP-SHAPED MARKINGS**
The dark markings on the sides of this adult seal curve upward to meet over the shoulders, forming a harp shape.